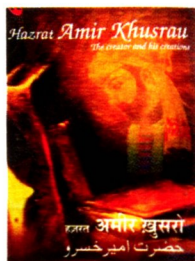


MUSIC REVIEW

Magic Returns

Immortal works of the great genius at Amir Khusrau have been sung by well-known singers who have interpreted the poetry in their own style. Khusrau believed in reaching out to the creator so he never lost his imagination and passion, which made him a true singer. In this twin album, each singer has sung in different forms created by Khusrau—be it the Khayal, Gul, Lohe, Qawwali, Sawan Geet, Kaul. The list of singers is a good mix ranging from the 99-year-old Ustad Abdul



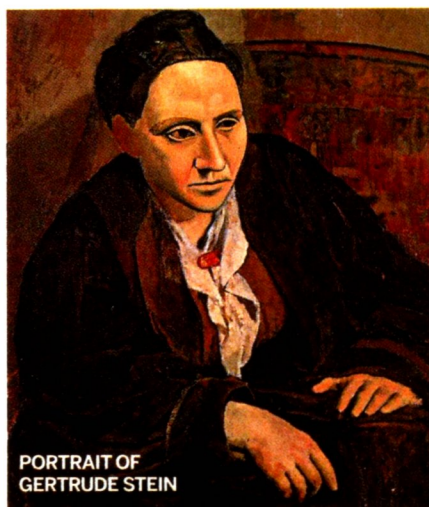
HAZRAT AMIR Khusrau

Ninaad Rs 500

Rasheed Khan from Kolkata to the well-known qawwal, Munnawar Masoom. Ustad Aslam Khan sings the Kaul and explores it with a tarana. Rasheed Khan sings the *Gul Mohammad Gulisto*—a verse in praise of the prophet Hazrat Mohammad and Hazrat Bibi Fatima. His voice still has that magic in the higher octaves. The mystic couplets, Dohe, have been sung by Shubha Joshi. Sitar maestro Shujaat Khan not only plays the sitar but also breaks into song, singing Khusrau's couplets. Don't miss the Chishti Brothers going ecstatic with *Aaj rang hai*. You will not be disappointed with these earthy robust voices. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

THEATRE

Full of LIFE



PORTRAIT OF GERTRUDE STEIN

When people told Pablo Picasso that Gertrude Stein did not resemble the portrait he had created of hers, he would respond, "She will". And, she did. Today the Portrait of Gertrude Stein-1906 hangs in the Metropolitan Museum in New York.

What: A theatre performance *Gertrude* which brings alive the life and times of one of the most celebrated literary luminaries of the last century. Gertrude Stein was an American writer who spent most of her life in Paris. Her salon at 27 Rue de Fleurus acquired international fame thanks to her circle of friends and protégés, including Henri Matisse, Paul Cezanne and Picasso. The act is woven around anecdotes in Stein's life and relationships with poets and artists of the time.

Who: Performed by Phyllis Bose who formed *The Actor's Company* in Calcutta in the 80s and *Shoestring Theatre* in Bangalore. An actor, director and a teacher who has performed numerous plays of Chekov, Moliere and Pinter, Bose devised a series of one-woman shows based on literary figures, of which *Gertrude* is one.

Where: At Ranga Shankara, Bangalore, on June 20. Will be taken to other cities soon.

by Nirmala Ravindran

DANCE

Steps to GLORY

Born on a full moon night, she was named Yamini 'Poornatilaka' Krishnamurthy by her grandfather who had predicted that she would become a great artiste. As a child she roamed nearby temples, lingering among the sculptures and listening to bhajans. "I knew I was born to dance," she says. Very few dancers are proficient in one form but Krishnamurthy excels in Bharatanatyam, Kuchipudi and Odissi. Learning the Kuchipudi was pure accident. "In Chennai an old man came to my home and told me that it was a shame that being from Andhra, I was not proficient in the dance form. He taught me Dasavataram and Odissi. I learnt from many gurus. Kuchipudi has a scintillating storytelling quality and I fell in love with the form," she says. That was the beginning of her journey. Krishnamurthy introduced Kuchipudi to Delhi and foreign audiences. She also made a TV serial capturing the Bhakti movement in Kuchipudi. On June 29, Krishnamurthy will be performing at the Habitat Centre, Delhi, to be followed by Prateek Chaudhari's sitar recital. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

